

Data Science Community for Health and Care Newsletter December 2024

Jennifer Struthers, Amaia Imaz-Blanco

2024-12-20



Welcome to the latest newsletter from the Data Science Community for Health and Care, brought to you by the NHS England Data Science Professional Development Functional Team.

The newsletter team are always happy to receive constructive feedback, and we invite you to send us any contributions you may have.

If you cannot access something of interest to you, please [reach out](#).

Thanks for reading! – newsletter team

Microsoft Hack



The NHS England Data Science team, as well as a range of other analysts from across the organisation, attended an AI Hackathon at Microsoft, organised by the Data Science Team together with Microsoft and Kainos, with the key stakeholders being the NHS Websites Services Team. In this article, the author shares her experiences at the event.

Last week, the long awaited Hack for Health hosted at the beautiful Story Club, in Paddington London, by Microsoft and NHSE finally happened! At the hackathon, every team had either a Kainos or Microsoft representative, as well as a range of participants from across NHS England, including a strong Data Science Team presence, with several of our team members in each group. And unlike a usual hackathon, this one had stakeholders and well defined use cases, we were all working to one common goal.

[Continue reading...](#)

Christmas Challenges

GCHQ Christmas Challenge

GCHQ have released their annual [Christmas Challenge](#). While aimed at children aged 11-18 we had a great time puzzling this one out during a morning Christmas meeting - perfect for a family Christmas quiz night!

RSS Christmas Quiz + Puzzles

The Royal Statistical Society have published their Christmas quiz and puzzles. There are even prizes for answering - the top three entries received by the deadline (**20:00 Sunday 5th January 2025**) will receive a donation of up to £150 to a charity of good cause of their choice.

The Section A quiz questions can be found [here](#), while the Section B puzzles can be found in PDF format [here](#) on linked on their own site: thexmaspuzzles.com.

Note: This site may not be accessible through work laptops

BBC Bitesize: AI or real? Christmas edition!

Artificial intelligence is already very impressive, with many AI images and videos so flawless that it can be difficult to tell what's fake and what's real. But as it continues to develop, will this become an impossible task?

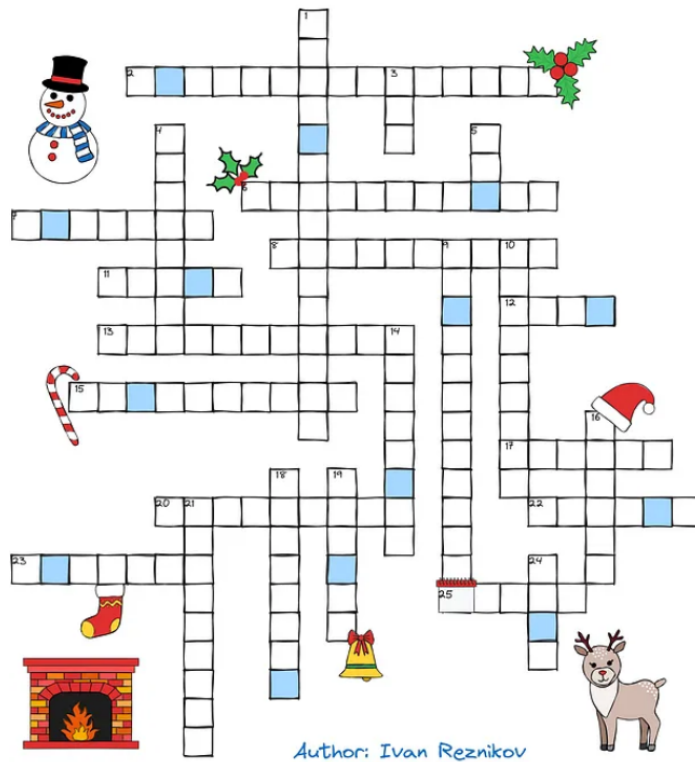
Challenge yourself with this Christmas edition of [AI or real!](#)

Christmas Crossword

Love crosswords? Love Machine Learning and AI? Last year Ivan Reznikov published a [Christmas Data Science Crossword Puzzle](#).

Your family will love solving this together after Christmas dinner and definitely not throw wrapping paper at your head!

Data Science Christmas Crossword Puzzle



1. Evaluating multiple models to find the best one
2. Neural network self-improvement through error analysis and adjustment
3. Unites gamers and data scientists
4. AI masks truth with digital illusions
5. GPT3/4, Mistral, Vicuna
6. Not Optimus Prime, but also powerful
7. OpenAI claim to fame
8. AI company that generates HQ images in Discord
9. AI's method of learning from mistakes
10. Compressed representation of something
11. Camel-like language model
12. If ML pick training favorites, rather than fairness
13. When you're Magnus Carlsen during train and blunder every move on test
14. Sometimes it fades, sometimes it explodes
15. Without it, everything would be linear
16. Command to control AI output
17. The building block of deep learning
18. Measure of how well an AI model performs
19. Flying language model
20. Framework for creating applications with Large Language Models
21. All you need
22. In LSTM, it's both long-term and short-term
23. Thanos for the world of neural networks
24. One of the street muppets or two-way NLP street since 2018
25. Blockchain transferrable asset or smallest chunk of text

Figure 1: Christmas Crossword: click the image to go to the site

RPySOC: Relive the experience

As mentioned in last month's newsletter, the RPySOC conference was hosted, bringing together enthusiasts of all things R, Python and Open Source software from all over the country. In the spirit of things being open and freely available, the talks and slides have been made available to you all to watch in your own time!

- [Link to slides held in GitHub](#)
- [Link to recordings hosted on YouTube](#)

Resources

For some, the festive period can allow a little bit of a reprieve from projects and meetings: the perfect time to do that training you always wanted to do but never had the time for. Consider blocking out some time for yourself to hit your learning goals!

Intro to Coding

The team have been busy updating the resources page of the FutureNHS site (free account required to access), including a new section full of resources on how to get started with Python.

There are so many great resources to get you started on a data science journey.

Intro to LLMs

Sam and Adam Hollings have a public repository which will walk you through some simple LLM implementations. It uses free software and can all be run inside Google Collab, for maximum accessibility. It could not be easier to start learning about this essential area of data science!

Check out our collection of training resources in the [Resources Section](#)! Can you spot something missing? [Contact us](#)!

Need a Quick Break?

[How many tries will it take you?](#)

[Subscribe to the community](#)[Contribute](#)[PDF Version](#)